

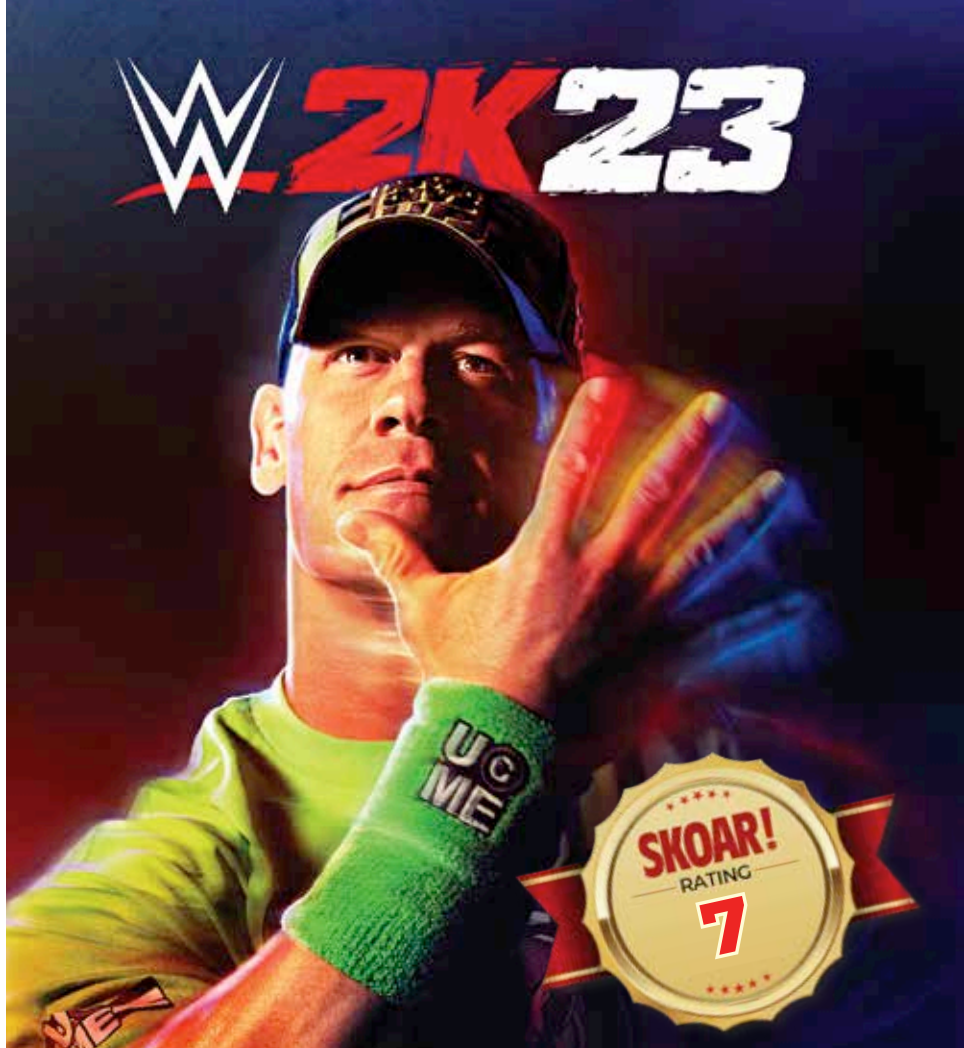
**T**oday, we're stepping into the squared circle to talk about 2K's WWE video game series. Now Despite its ups and downs over the years, the WWE 2K series has been a staple of the gaming world since its inception. The WWE 2K series can trace its roots all the way back to 2000 with the release of "WWF SmackDown!" for the PlayStation. From there, the series went through various name changes and publishers until it eventually landed in the hands of 2K Sports in 2013. Since then, the series has had its share of highs and lows. There have been years where the games were top-notch, offering realistic gameplay and an extensive roster of wrestlers. And then there were years where the games were, well, not so great.

But before we dive into the nitty-gritty, let's start with a joke. You know, WWE and gaming have a lot in common. They both involve people performing ridiculous feats of athleticism, and they both have a tendency to rely on flashy graphics and special effects to distract you from the fact that it isn't actually real. If you're a 10-year-old kid who loves WWE, I hate to break to ya champ - we can all see John Cena!

### Combat And Graphics - Learning How To Fight

We dive straight into the action with the help of the one and only Xavier Woods, who shows us the ropes of basic gameplay mechanics. The game introduces us to the trusty bag of tricks including jabs, hooks, grapples, and blocks, all jumbled up into some savage combos that'll knock our opponents for a loop. And if that's not enough to make you wanna smash some buttons, there's even a damage meter to show just how much pain each character's body has taken. It'll come in handy when it's time to submit or pin 'em down for the count.

Although there are moments when the graphics stand out, it's not always



## IF IT AIN'T BROKE, DON'T FIX IT

**WWE 2K 23 builds upon the foundation of the last year's game but is that enough for the game to stand on its own?**

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the case. Most players coming from WWE 2K 22 won't likely see a huge change in terms of visuals. But that's not to say that the game looks bad by any measurement. Cutscenes look very detailed, you can see great detail of wrestlers' biceps, triceps, and other muscles. In the actual gameplay as well, the crowd looks realistic and every grab move feels the same as well. There wasn't any moment when it felt that a punch or a grab lacks an impact. My only complaint visually

would be the lack of details in the fight stage area. The pillars covering the stage looked relatively bad compared to the rest of the scene.

The actual combat is relatively simple. You will face some initial difficulties in reacting and timing your grabs initially but will soon get the hang of it after two or three fights. The fight flows freely once you start mixing different combos and throwing special moves. What further adds to the match's intensity is that the game